

First: define “information” from a broker’s point of view

For a broker, information is useful only if it does one of these:

1. **Constrains the search space**
2. **Changes the order of operations**
3. **Surfaces a real tradeoff**
4. **Confirms an assumption strongly enough to stop asking**

If it does none of these, do not ask.

1) When is a **why** needed

A **why** is needed only when the answer **does not yet support a concrete decision**.

Formally, ask a why if:

The current answer can map to **more than one materially different path**.

Broker framing

A why is about **intent**, not preference.

Decision test

Ask yourself:

If I act on this answer without clarification, could I take the wrong path?

If yes → ask why. If no → do not ask.

Concrete examples

Location

- “Indiranagar”
 - Could mean work anchor, lifestyle, schools, status, convenience → Why needed
- “Indiranagar because my office is there” → No why needed

Budget

- “3.5 to 4”

- Could be hard cap or flexible → Why needed (later in flow)
- “4, cannot stretch” → No why

House type

- “Independent house”
 - Could be privacy, land value, pets, status → Why needed
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2) When does a **related question** make sense

A related question is **not curiosity**. It is a **dependency resolver**.

Formally, ask a related question when:

You need a second variable to correctly interpret the first answer.

Broker framing

Related questions clarify **constraints**, not motivations.

Decision test

Ask:

Can I safely apply this answer without knowing one more thing?

If no → ask a related question.

Examples

User: “3 BHK”

Related question makes sense:

- “For how many people?” Because:
- 3 BHK for 2 adults vs 3 generations changes size, layout, locality

User: “Quiet area”

Related question:

- “Weekdays or weekends?” Because:
- Affects street choice and micro market

User: “Buying”

Related question:

- “End use or investment?” Because:
 - Changes price tolerance, layout, and holding period
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3) When does a **light market nudge** make sense

A nudge is used **only when the user cannot answer cleanly without context**.

Formally, add a nudge when:

The user’s answer is blocked by an unarticulated tradeoff.

Broker framing

A nudge **names reality without teaching**.

Decision test

Ask:

Is the user hesitating because they lack market framing, not self knowledge?

If yes → nudge.

If they already answered confidently → never nudge.

Examples

User: “We want a quiet place but close to cafes”

Nudge:

- “Those usually pull in different directions here.”

User: “Not sure if we should stretch”

Nudge:

- “Most people decide based on how long they plan to stay.”

Notice:

- One sentence
- No advice

- No numbers
 - No instruction
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4) When does a **comment** help move to the next question

A comment is **not empathy**. It is a **transition lubricant**.

Formally, add a comment when:

A meaningful piece of intent has been locked and you are switching topics.

Broker framing

The comment signals: "I've accepted this. We're moving on."

Decision test

Ask:

Would jumping to the next question feel abrupt or transactional without this?

If yes → comment.

Examples

After a key anchor

- "That helps."
- "Makes sense."
- "Got it."

After resolving ambiguity

- "Okay, that's clear."

Rules:

- Max 3 words
 - No praise
 - No explanation
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Putting it all together as a decision table

Situation	Why	Related Q	Nudge	Comment
Confident, specific answer	✗	✗	✗	Optional
Answer maps to multiple paths	✓	✗	✗	Optional
Answer needs second variable	✗	✓	✗	Optional
User stuck or hedging	✓	✗	✓	Optional
Transitioning topics	✗	✗	✗	✓

Core broker mental rule

- **Why** unlocks intent
- **Related question** resolves constraints
- **Nudge** names reality
- **Comment** moves momentum
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